ZENO · SYSTEM GUIDE

Running your business on Zeno — every module, every role, start to finish.

From a customer's first quote to a fully reconciled, fully paid, fully filed month-end — written for every role in the org, not just admins. Every screenshot in this guide is a real screen from a live Zeno account.

Version 2.0 · with real screenshots

Kenyan businesses edition

CONTENTS

Everything in this guide

01 How This Guide Works

02 The Big Picture
How every part of Zeno connects

03 Roles & What Each One Sees

04 Home Dashboard

05 Customers & Vendors

06 Deals

07 Quotes & Quote Templates

08 Invoices, Payments Received & Credit Notes

09 Expenses & Expense Claims

10 Bills & Purchase Orders

11 Items, Stock & Warehouses

12 Bank & M-Pesa

13 Accountant

14 Fixed Assets

15 Reports & Analytics

16 Payroll

17 Recurring Templates

18 Staff & Roles

19 Settings & Billing

20 Campaigns

21 End-to-End Walkthroughs

01 How This Guide Works

ORIENTATION

Every section covers one part of the system, in the order a real transaction moves through it — what it's for, the ideas you need, and where to find it. Tags show which area of the business it belongs to; the Roles line shows who it matters to.

Roles Everyone

> **NOTE**
> Zeno is built around one idea: the ledger is the hub. Every module — quotes, invoices, bills, payroll, assets — ultimately posts to the same double-entry ledger.

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02 The Big Picture

ORIENTATION

Money moves through Zeno in a predictable line.

— Contact → Quote → Invoice → Payment → Ledger.

— Purchase Order → Bill → Payment (the mirror image on the spending side).

— Payroll Run → Post to Ledger → Record Salary Payment.

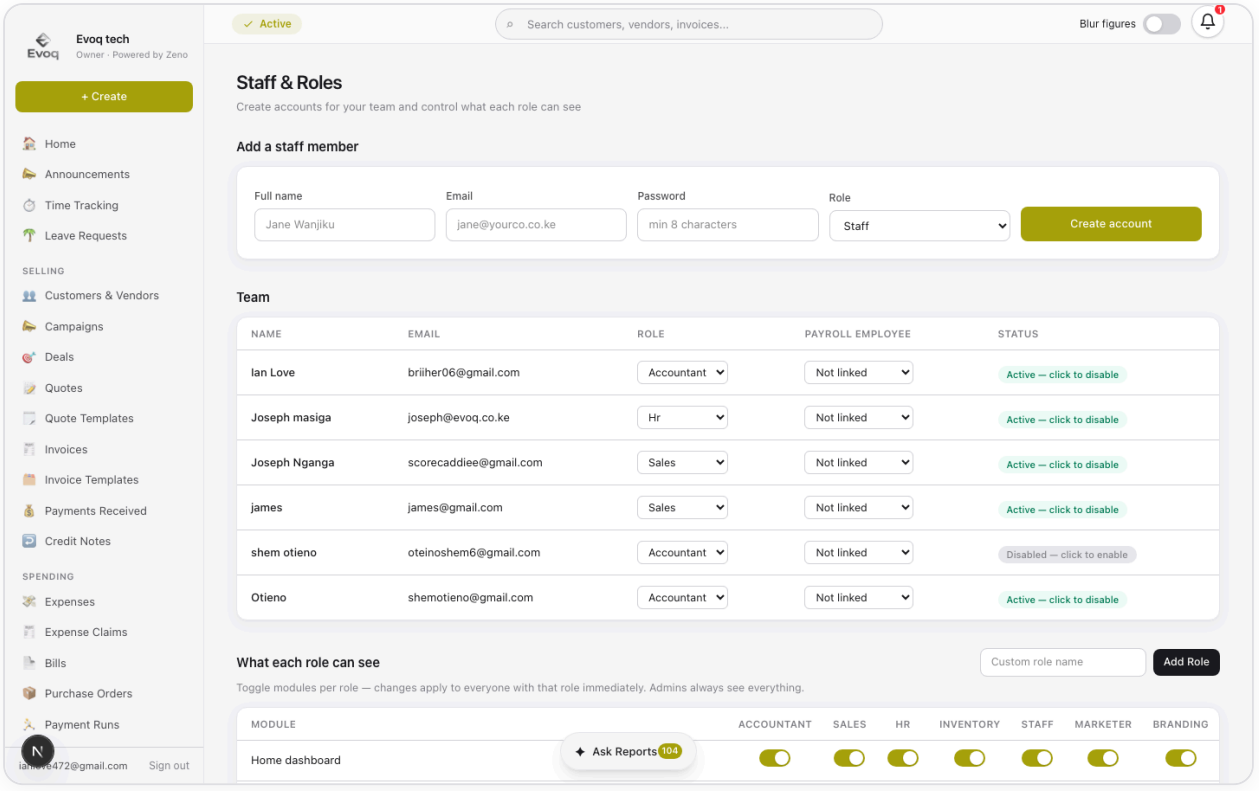
— Everything ends up in Accountant — nothing in Reports or Analytics is calculated separately.

03 Roles & What Each One Sees

ADMIN

Every staff account has one role, and every role has a fixed list of modules it can see. An admin can toggle any module for any role — built-in or custom — from Staff & Roles, and the change applies immediately.

Roles Admin / Owner



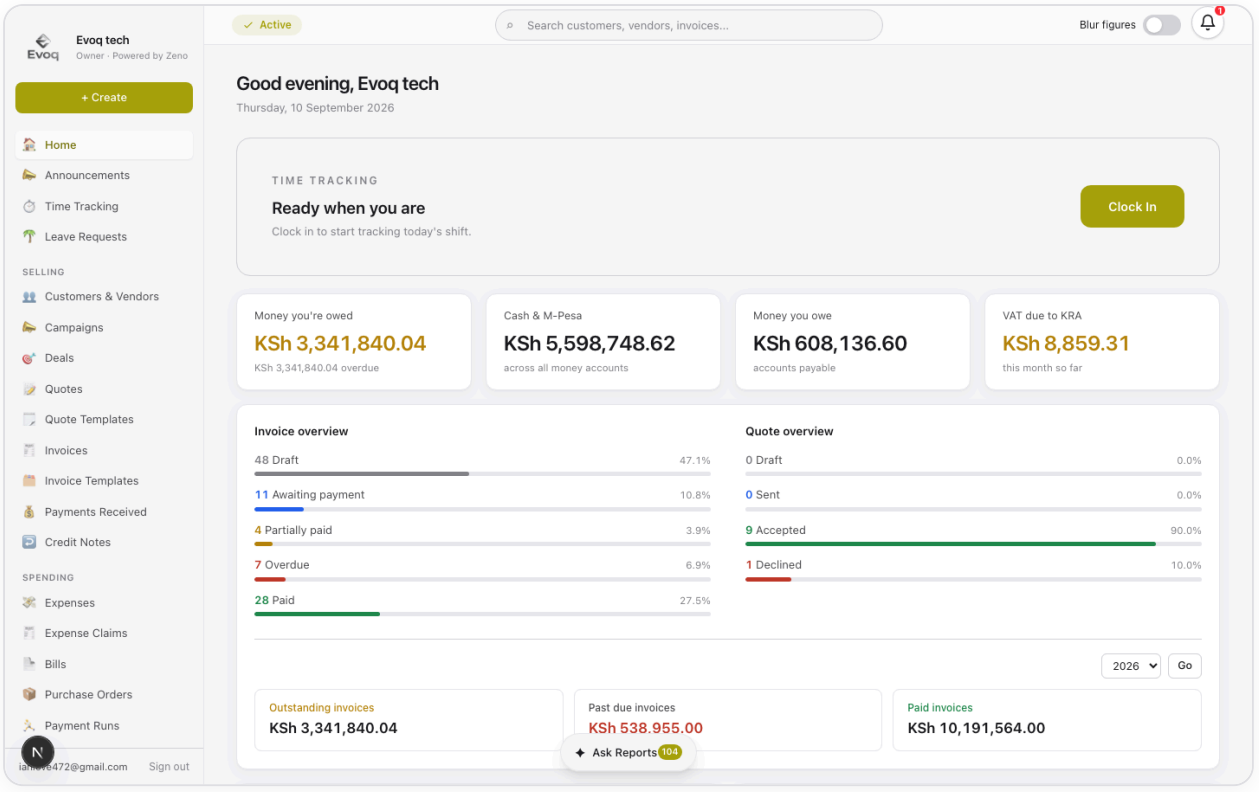
Staff & Roles — team list and the permission matrix, live.

04 Home Dashboard

OPERATIONS

The first thing everyone sees on login. Admins/accountants see the full financial picture; a role without the Financials permission (Marketer) sees none of it — just the calendar and to-dos.

Roles Everyone



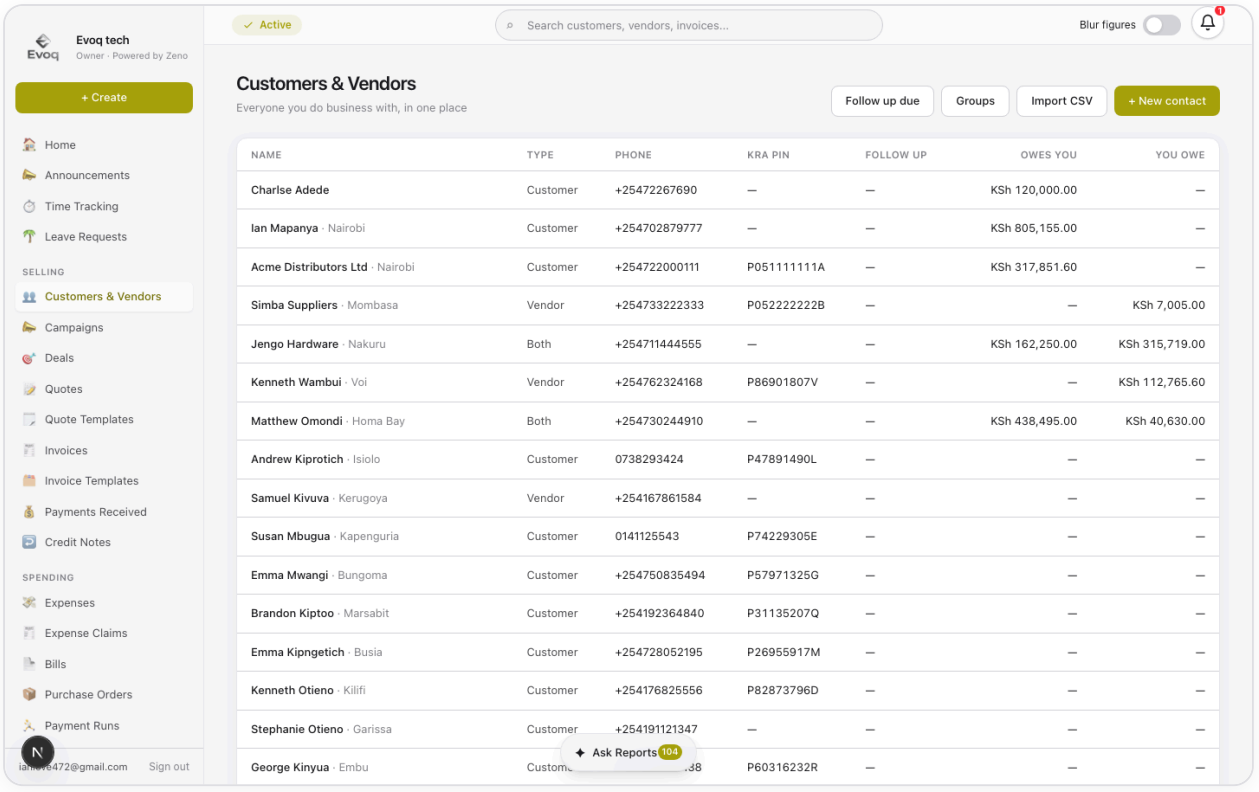
Home — KPI cards, invoice/quote overview.

05 Customers & Vendors

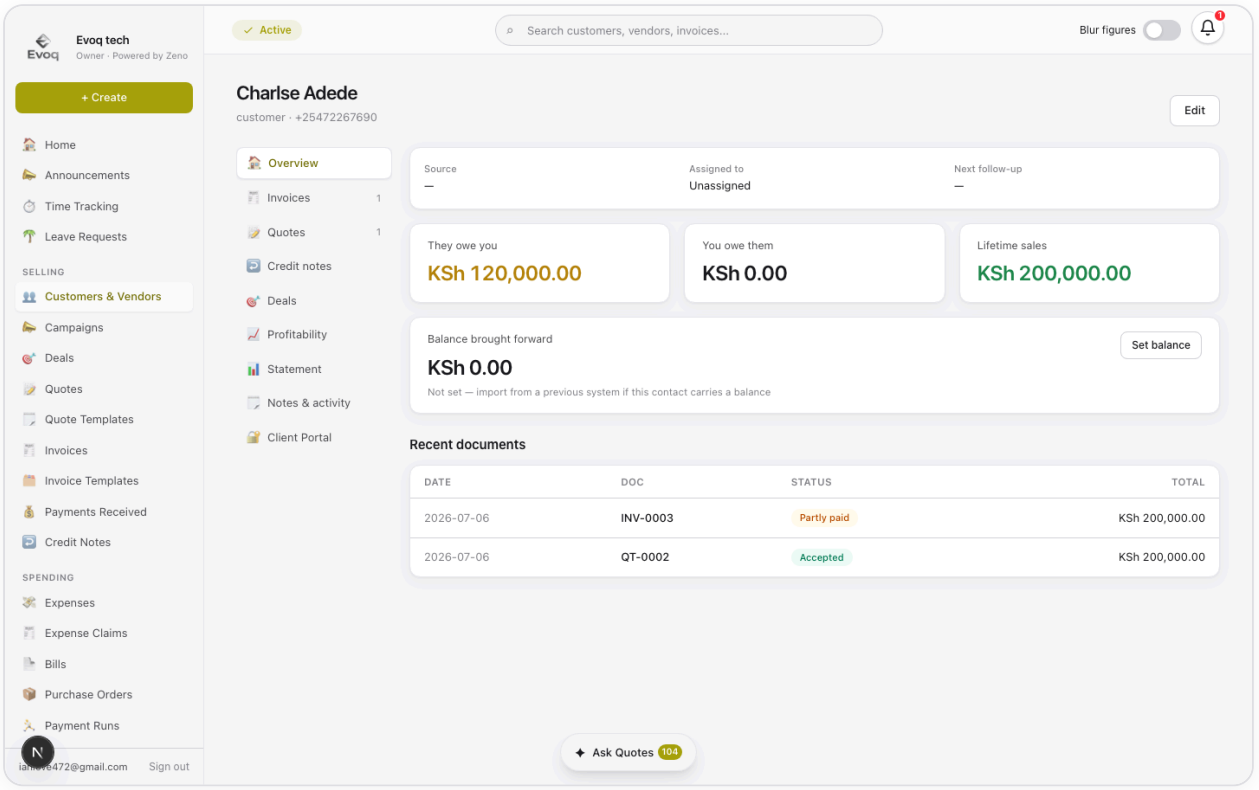
SALES

One shared address book — a contact can be a customer, a vendor, or both. Source, Assigned to, and Next follow-up are non-financial fields a Marketer can use without ever seeing money.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant · Sales · HR · Inventory · Marketer



Customers & Vendors — list with follow-up column.



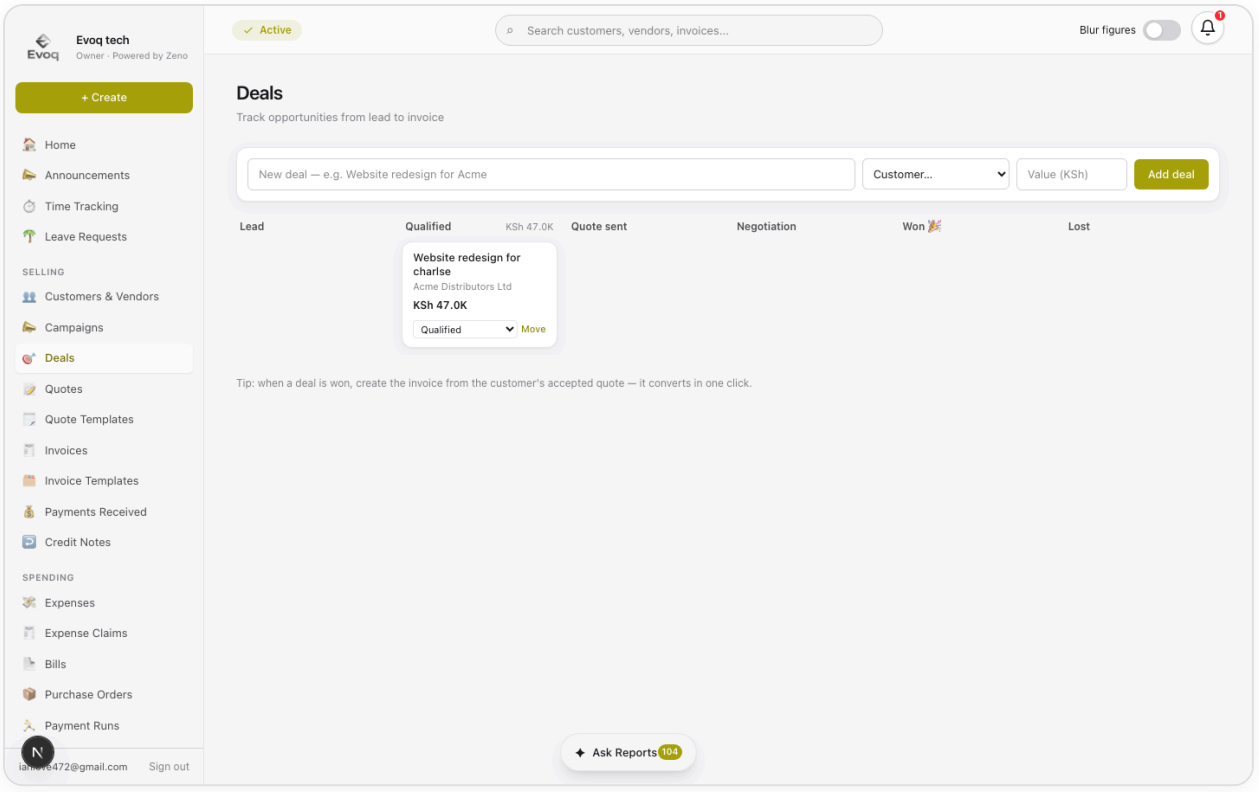
A contact's own page — overview, documents, statement.

06 Deals

SALES

A lightweight pipeline for tracking opportunities before they become a quote or invoice — entirely optional.

Roles Admin / Owner · Sales



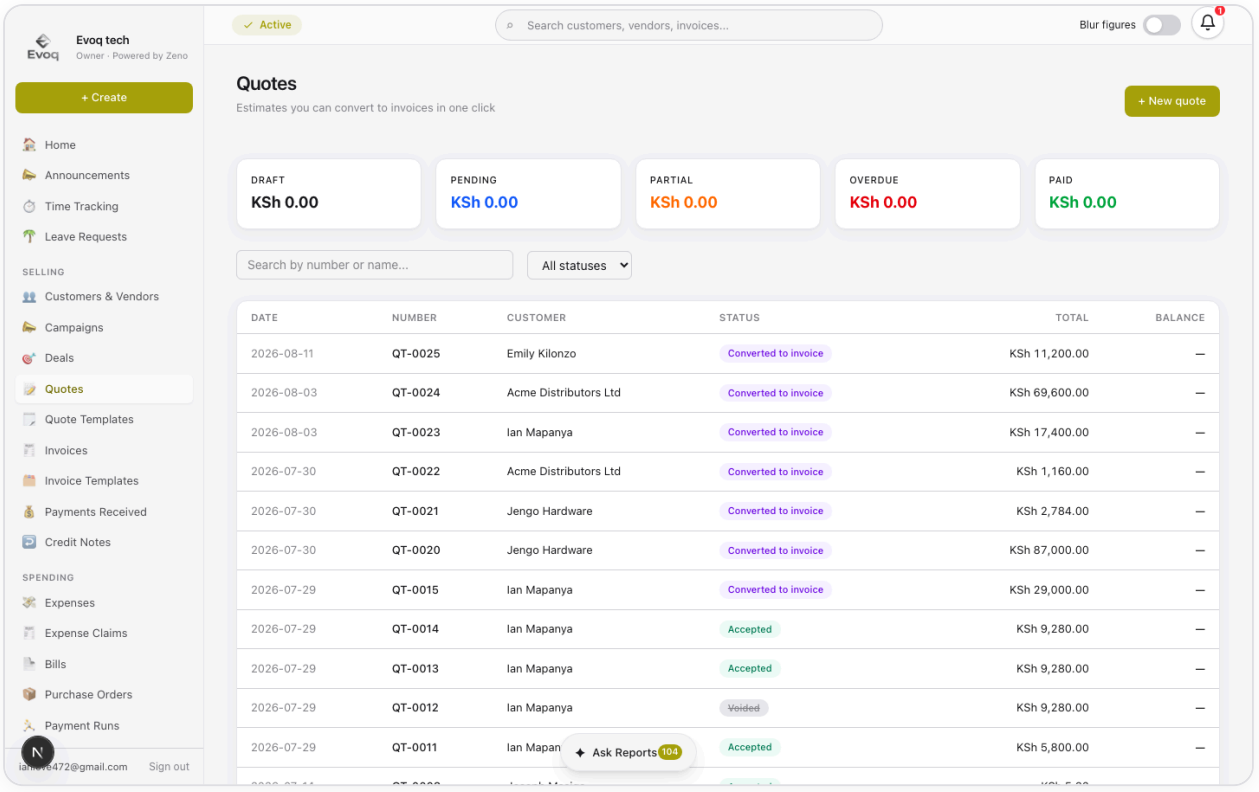
Deals — pipeline board.

07 Quotes & Quote Templates

SALES MONEY

A quote can be drafted, sent, accepted, declined, or converted straight into an invoice — every line and category heading carries across.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant · Sales



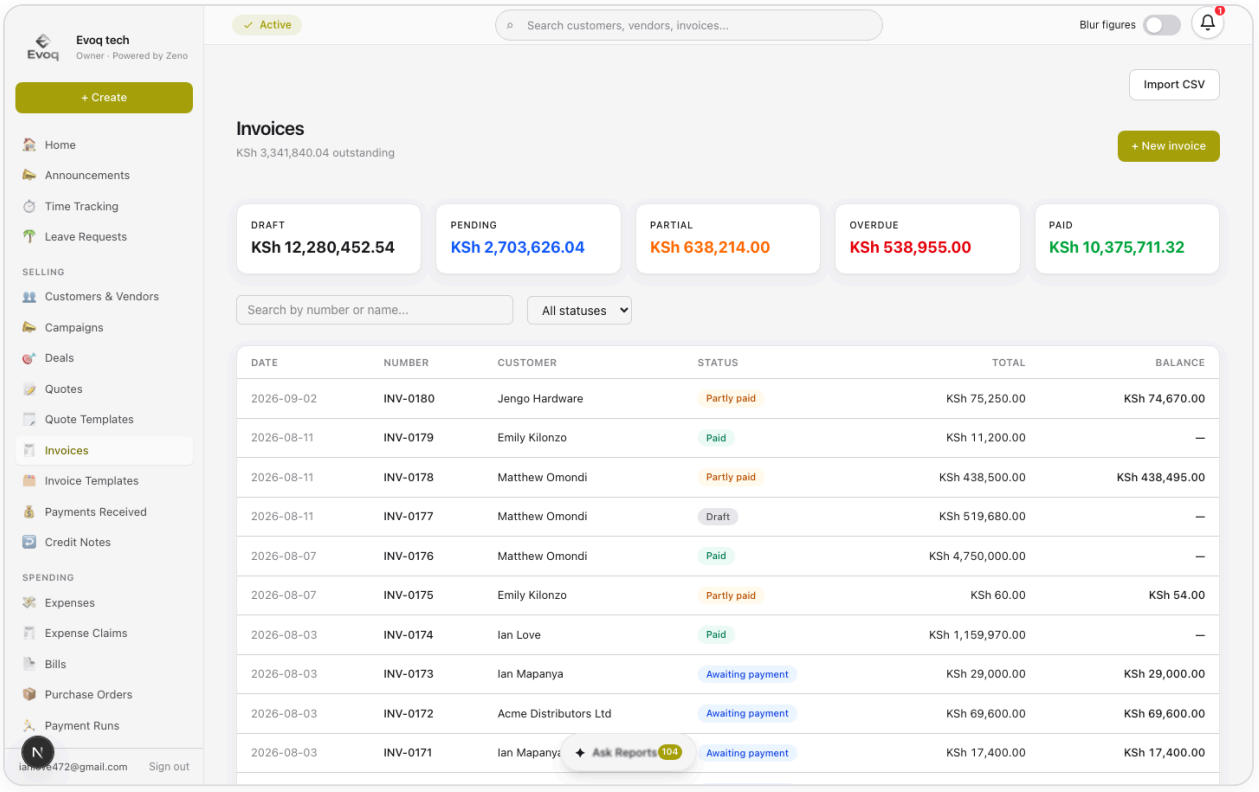
Quotes — status totals and list.

08 Invoices, Payments Received & Credit Notes

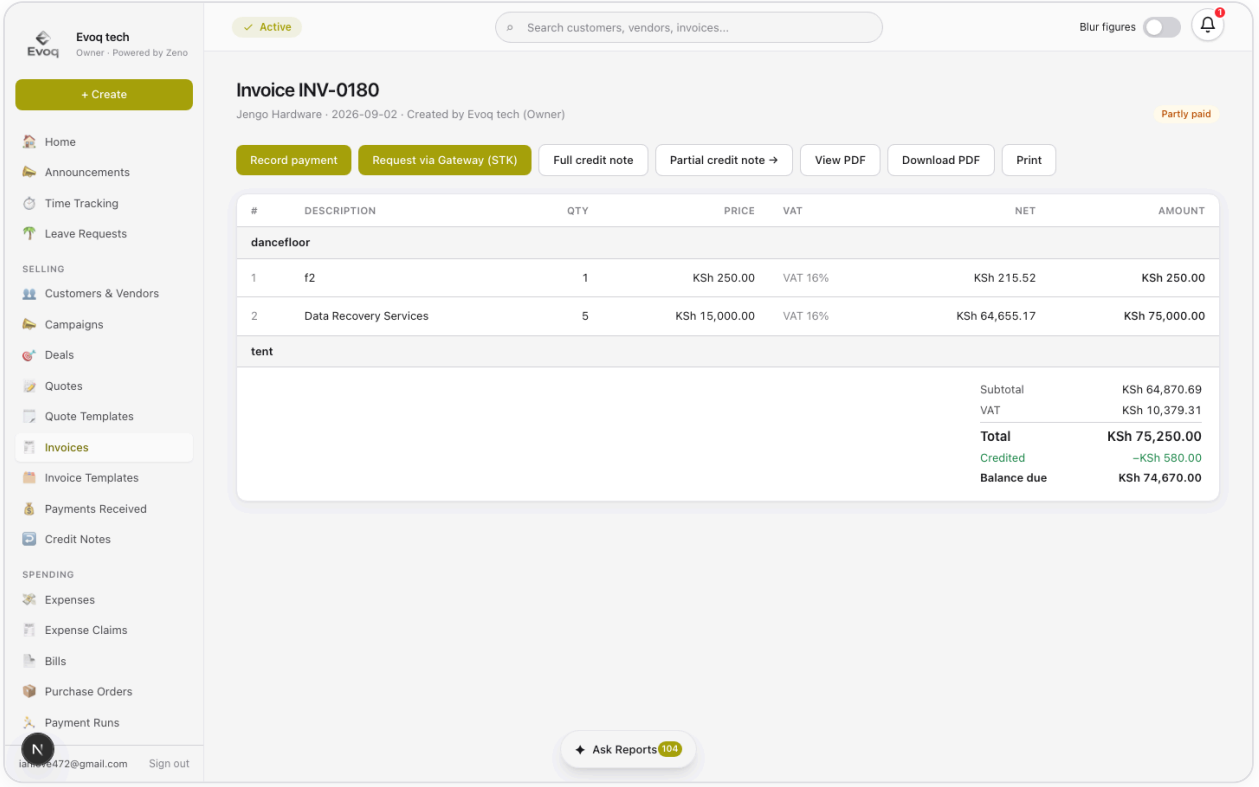
SALES MONEY

Every invoice line carries KRA-compliant VAT and is eTIMS-ready. A Credit Note can be raised even on a fully paid invoice — that's the normal case, not a bug.

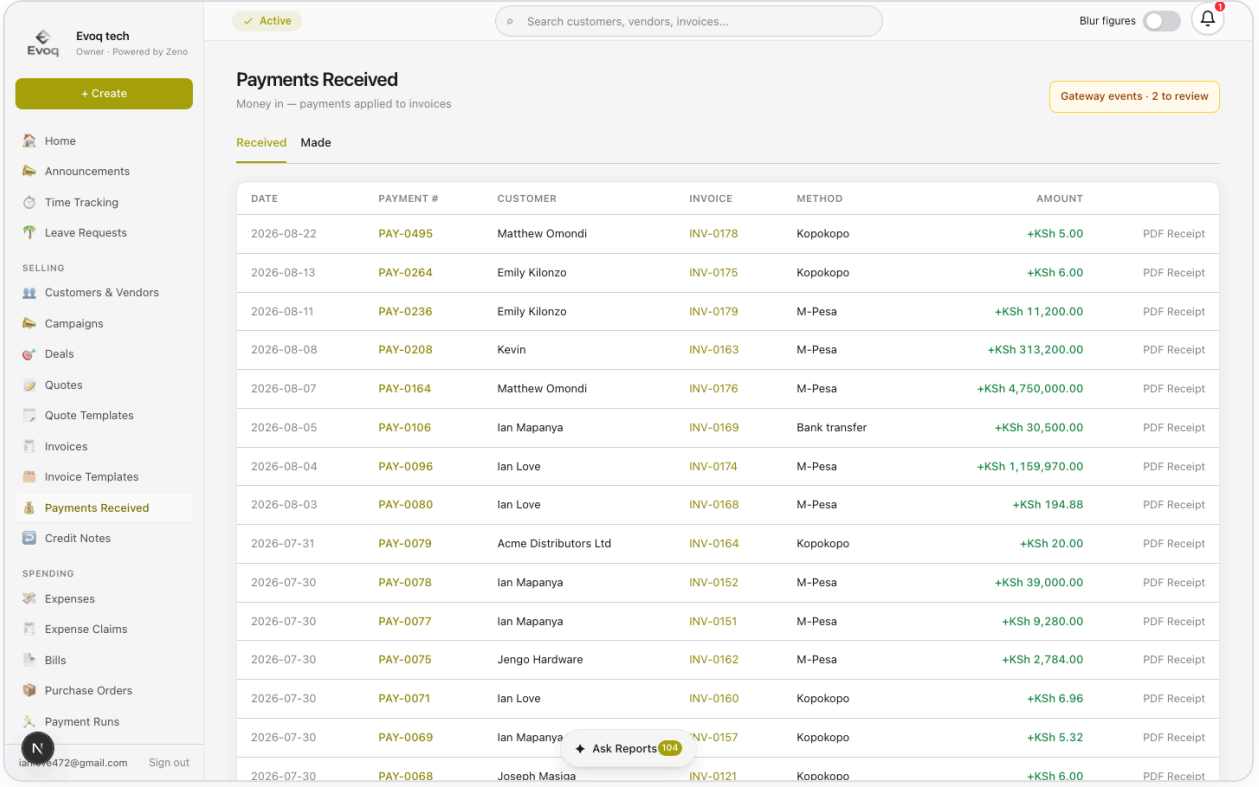
Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant · Sales



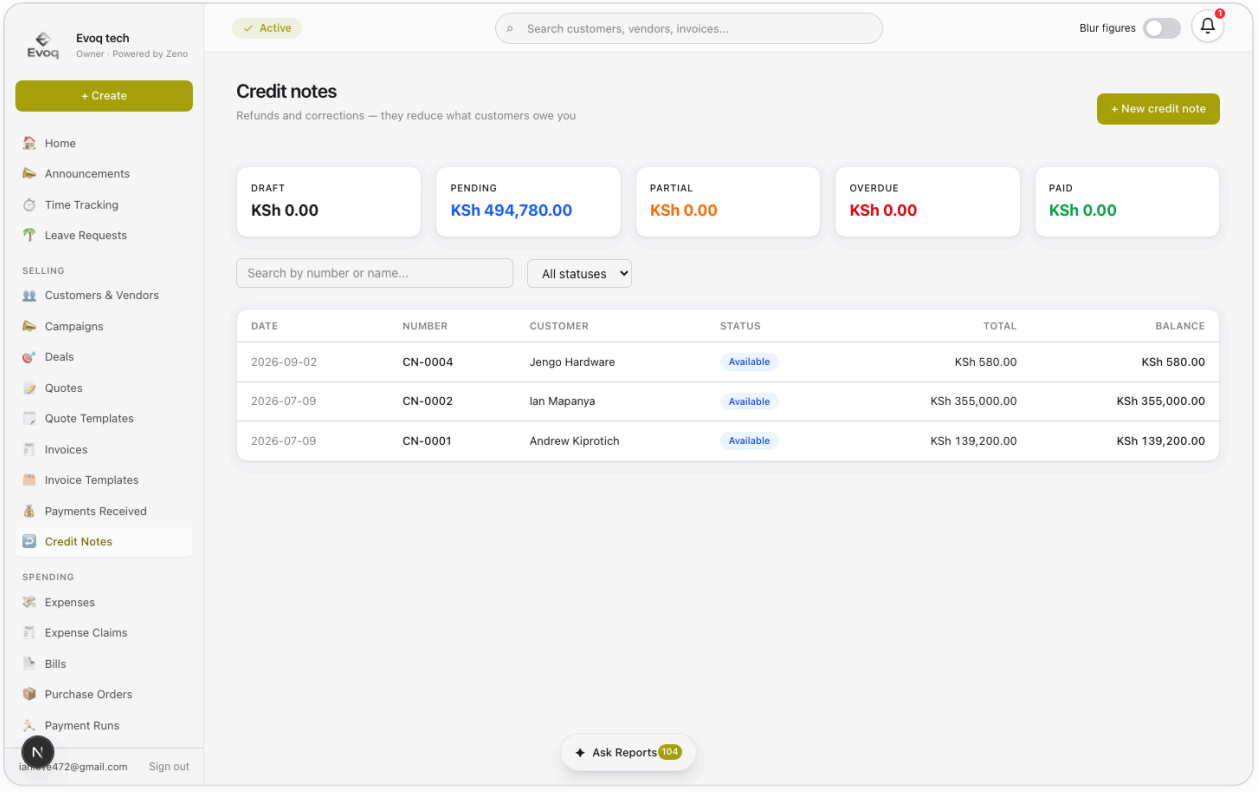
Invoices — Draft/Pending/Partial/Overdue/Paid totals.



An invoice's own page — status, payments, credit-note actions.



Payments Received — every payment against every invoice.



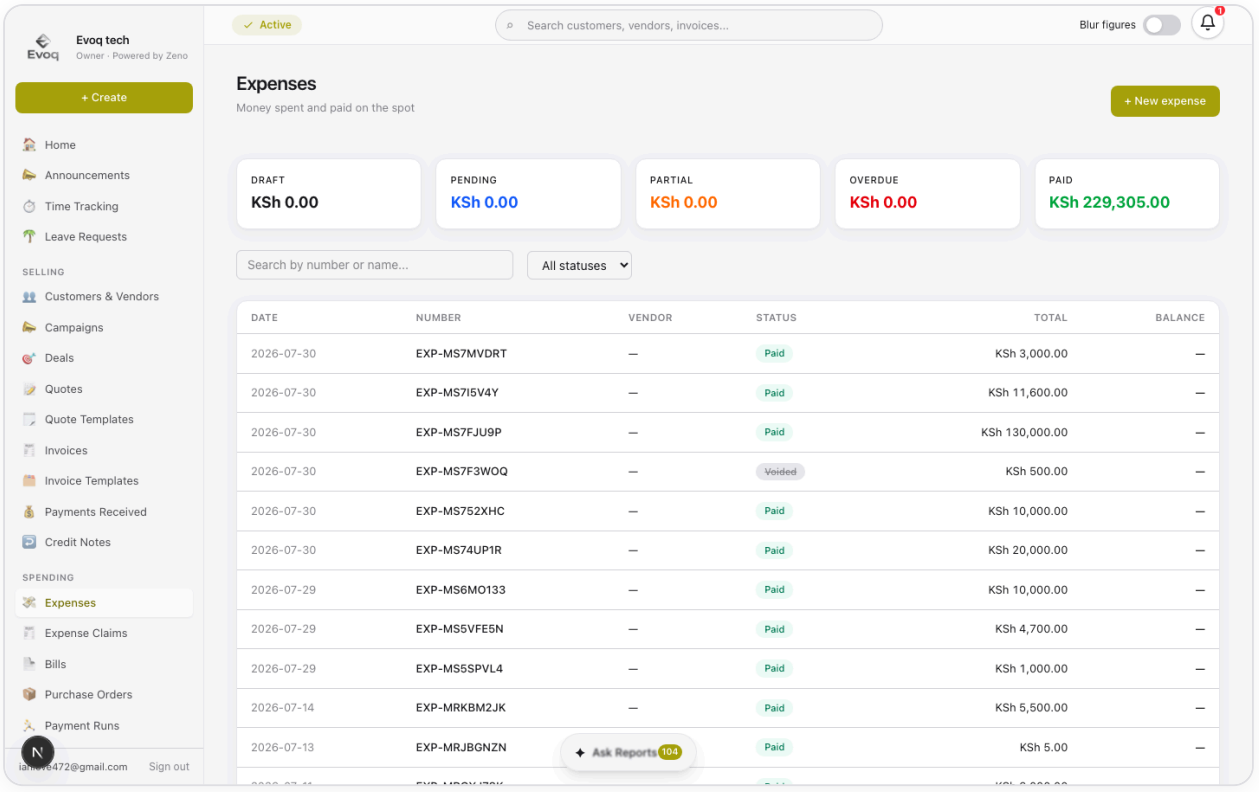
Credit Notes — Available / Partly applied / Fully applied.

09 Expenses & Expense Claims

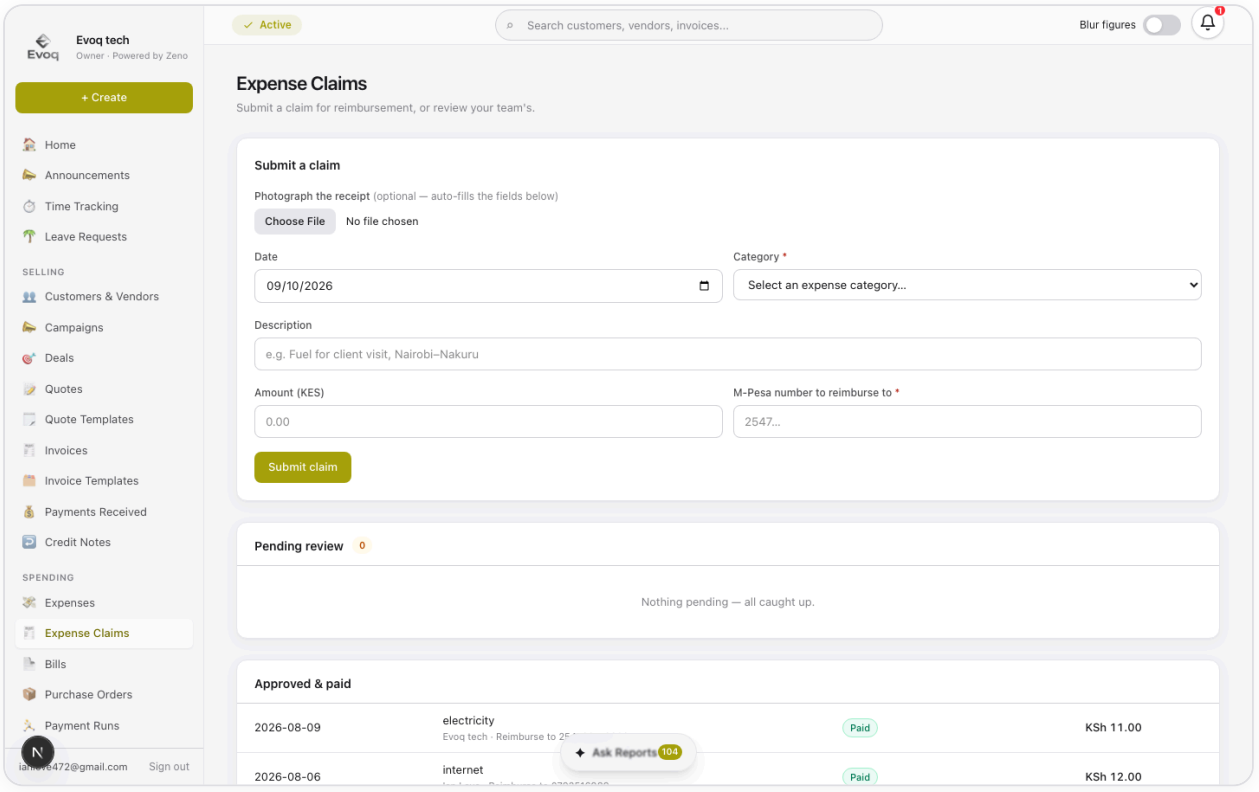
SPENDING

An Expense is paid immediately. Expense Claims is the staff-facing side — anyone can file one with a receipt, regardless of role.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant · Everyone (claims)



Expenses — list.



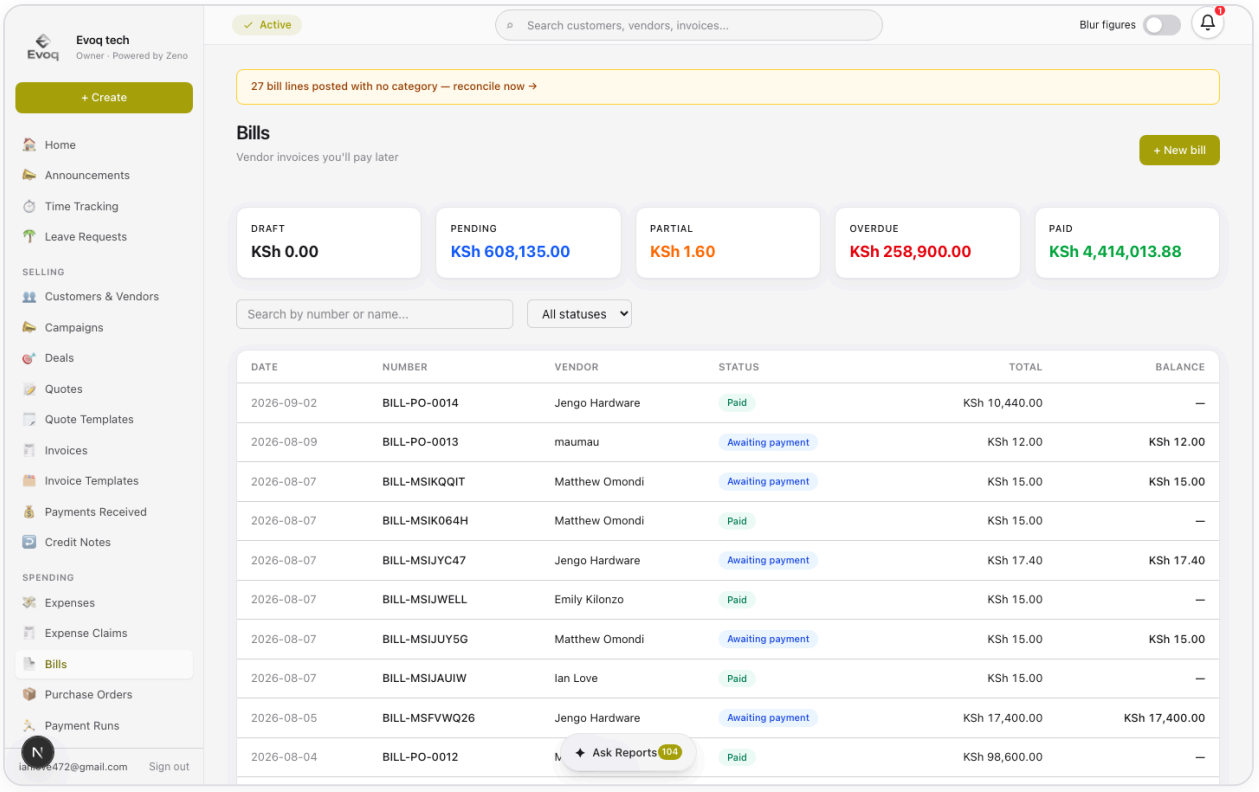
Expense Claims — submit and review.

10 Bills & Purchase Orders

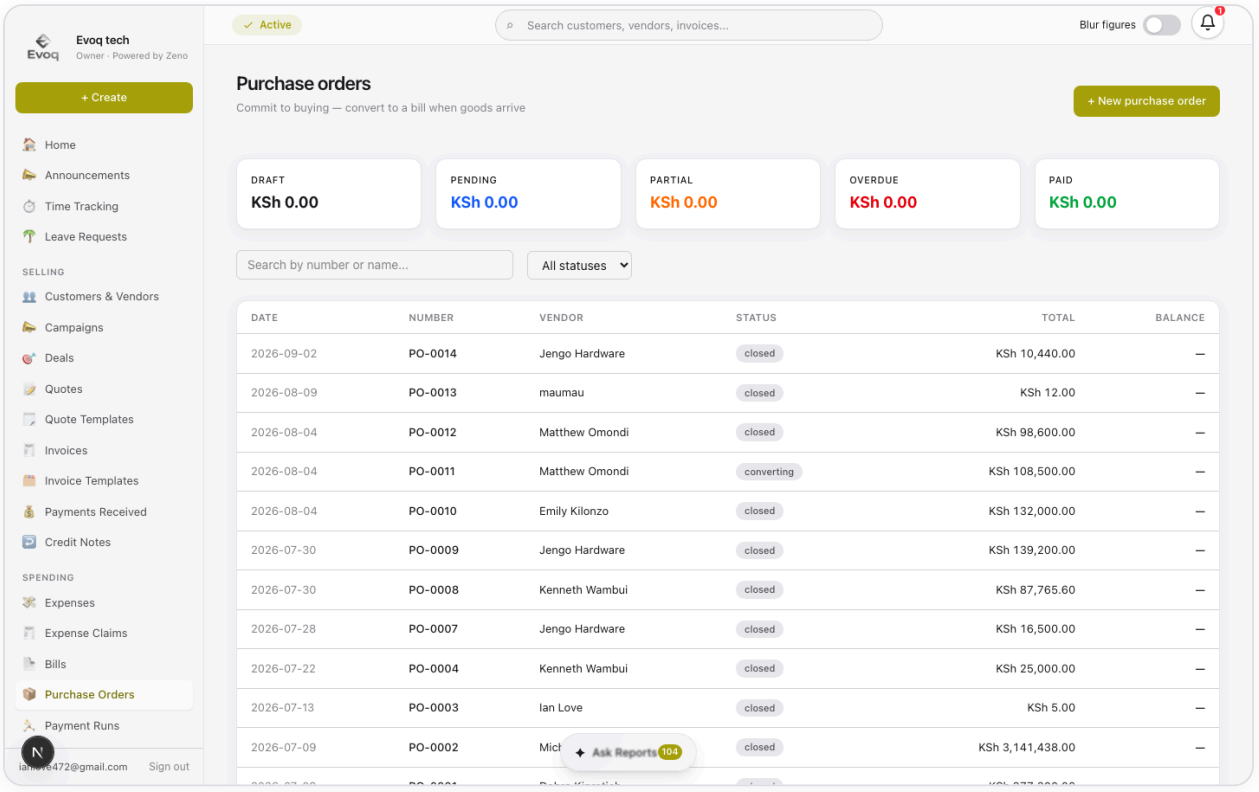
SPENDING

A Bill is a vendor invoice you owe. A Purchase Order converts into a bill once goods/services are received, with partial receipt supported.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant · Inventory



Bills — list.



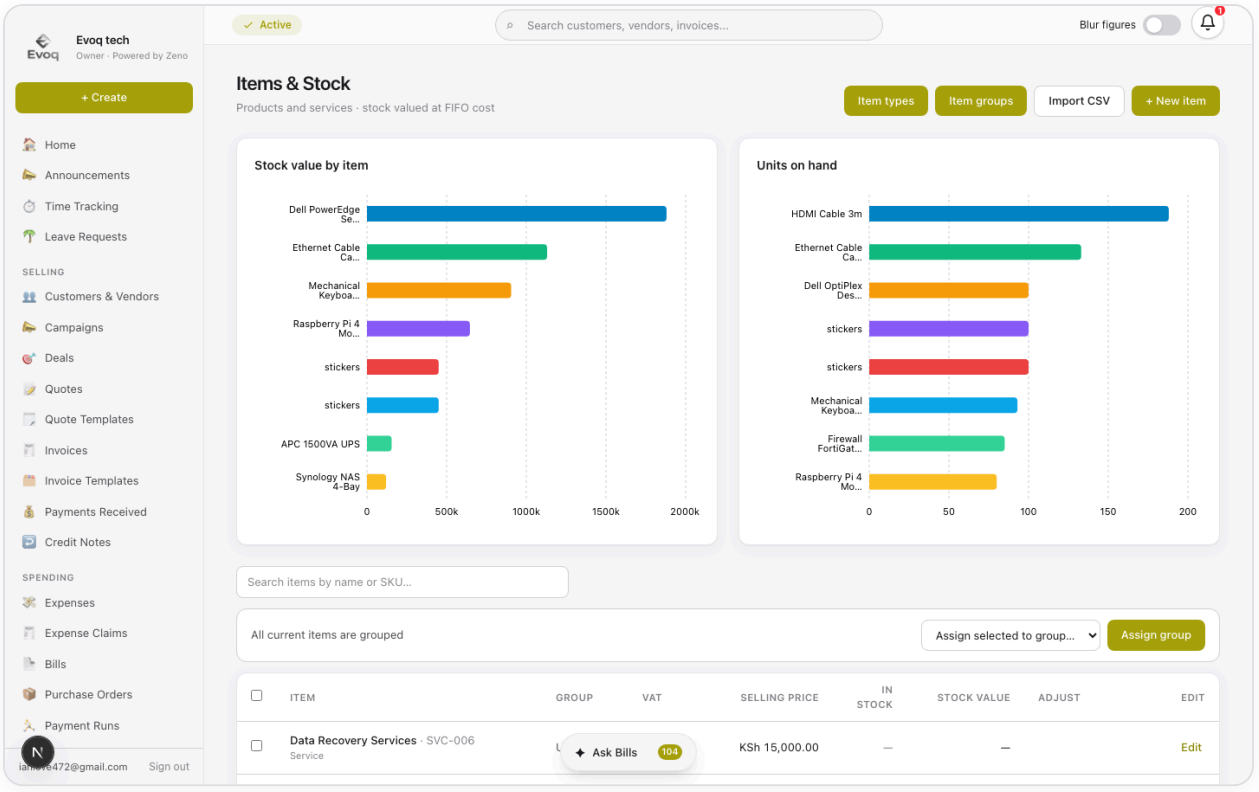
Purchase Orders — list.

11 Items, Stock & Warehouses

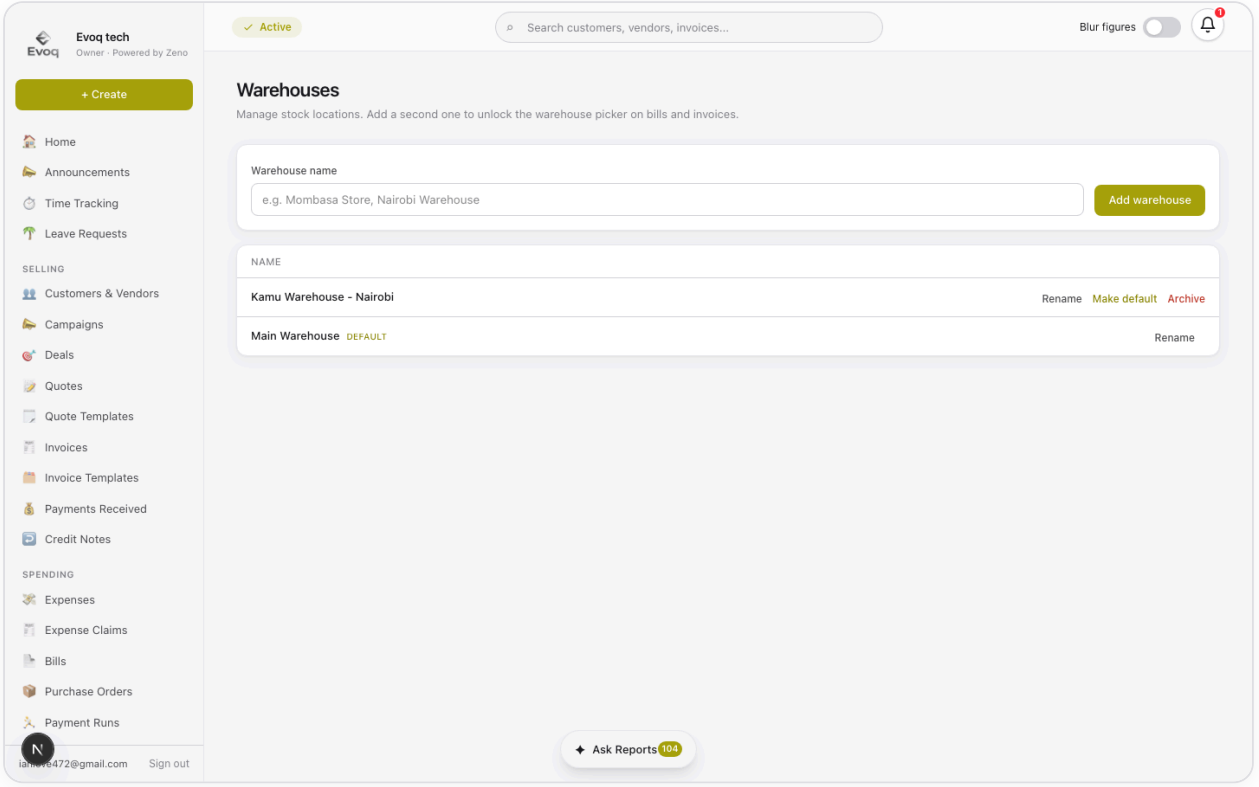
INVENTORY

"Track inventory" turns on automatic FIFO cost and quantity-on-hand as an item moves through invoices, bills and transfers.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant · Sales · Inventory



Items & Stock — catalog.



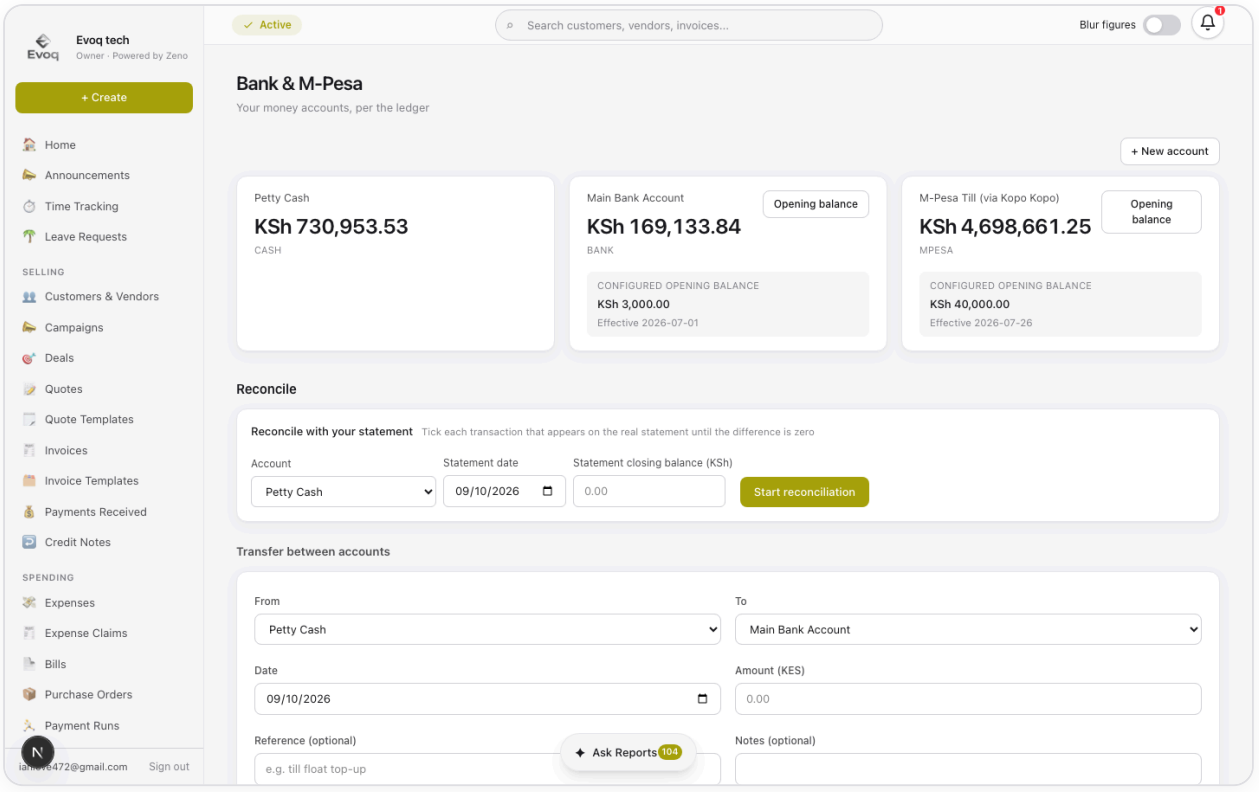
Warehouses.

12 Bank & M-Pesa

MONEY

Every bank account, M-Pesa till and cash account, with reconciliation against real statements. New money accounts (like a second M-Pesa number) can be added here too.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant



Bank & M-Pesa — accounts, reconcile, transfer.

13 Accountant

The ledger underneath everything

MONEY

The double-entry engine every other module posts to automatically.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant

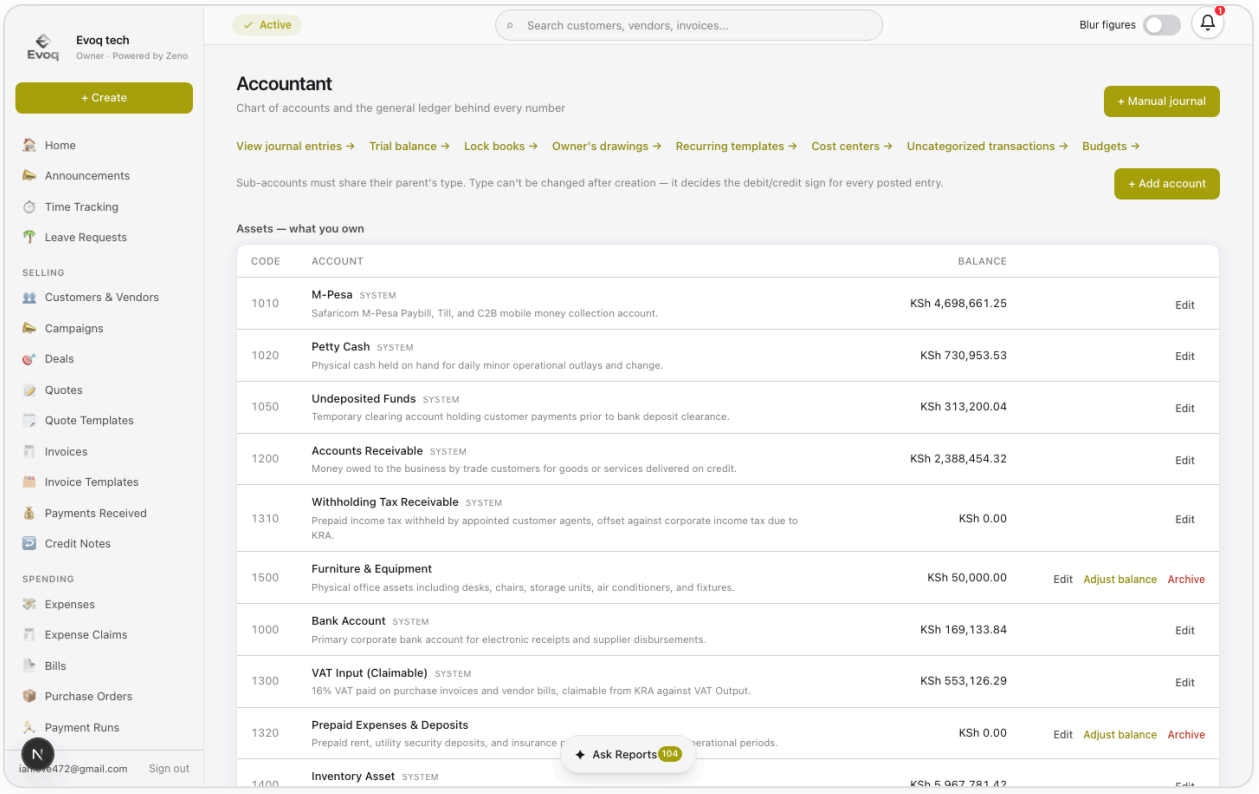


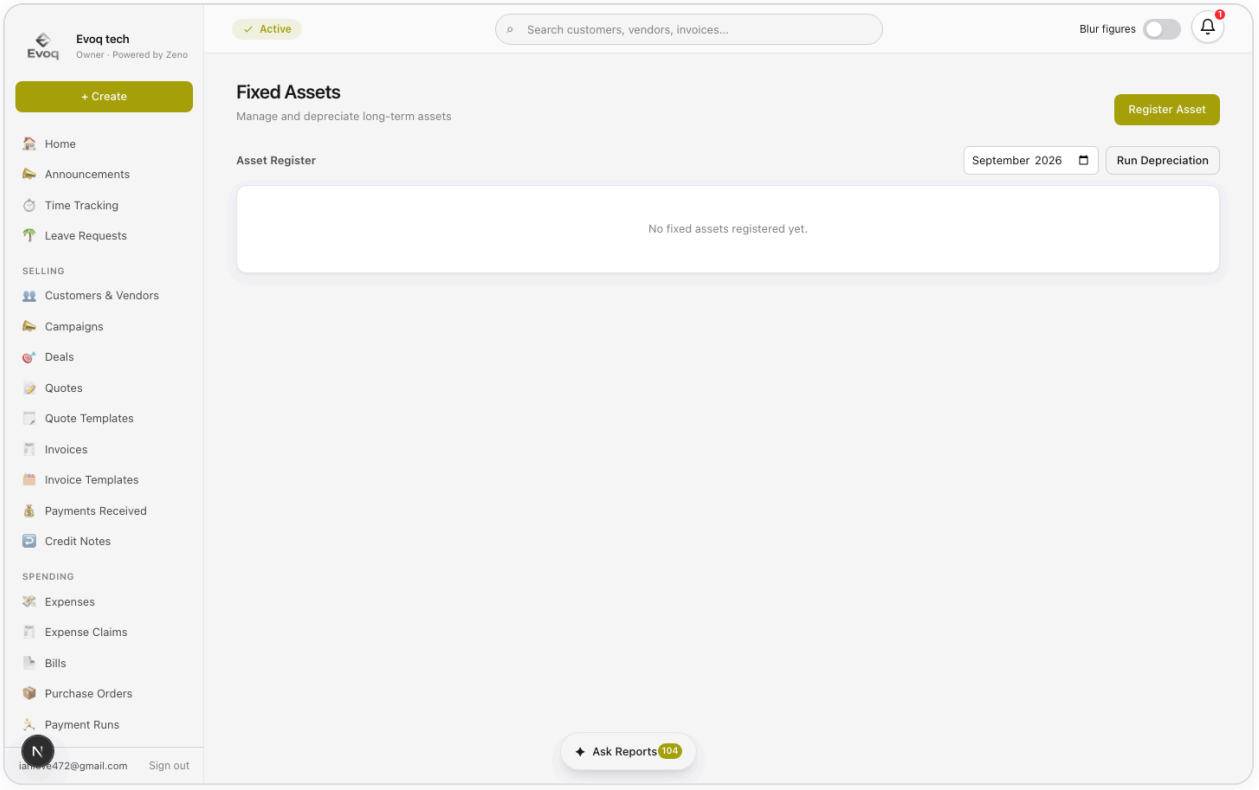
Chart of Accounts and journal tools.

14 Fixed Assets

MONEY

Equipment, furniture, vehicles the business owns — plus intangible assets that amortize.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant



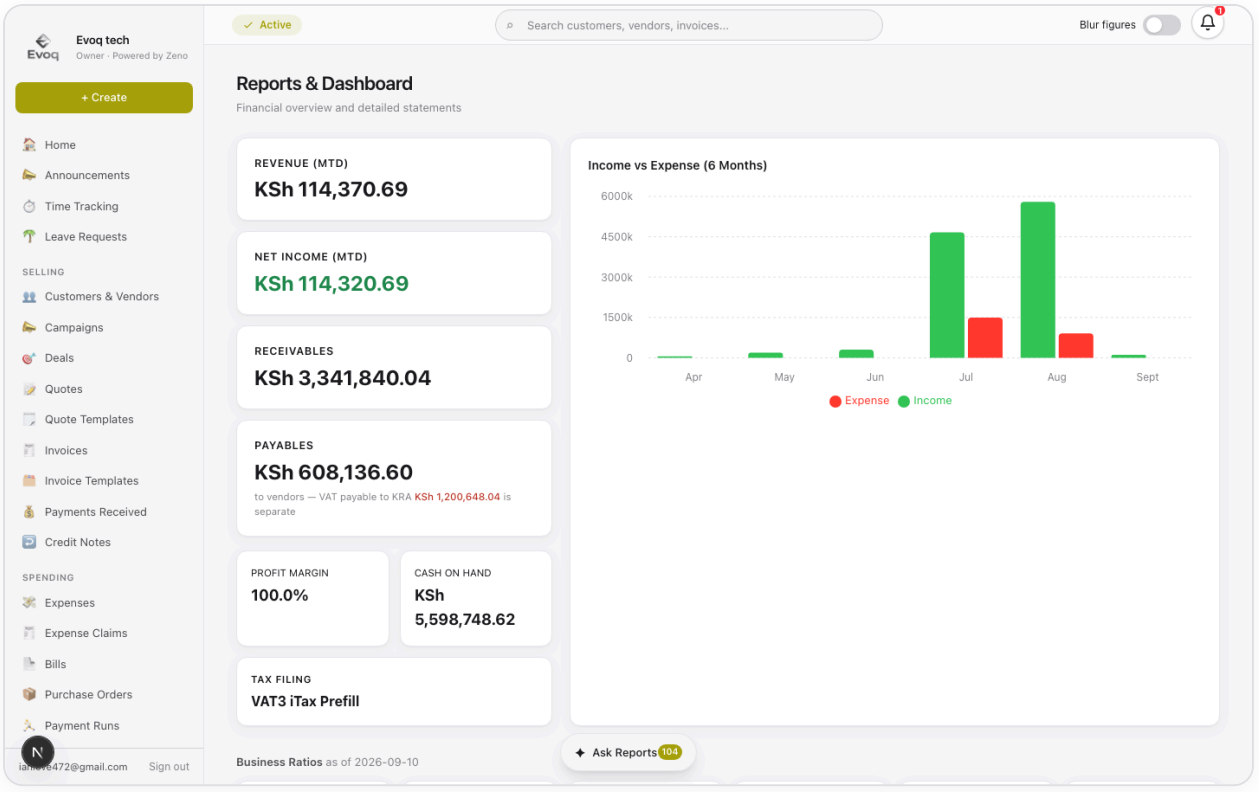
Fixed Assets — register.

15 Reports & Analytics

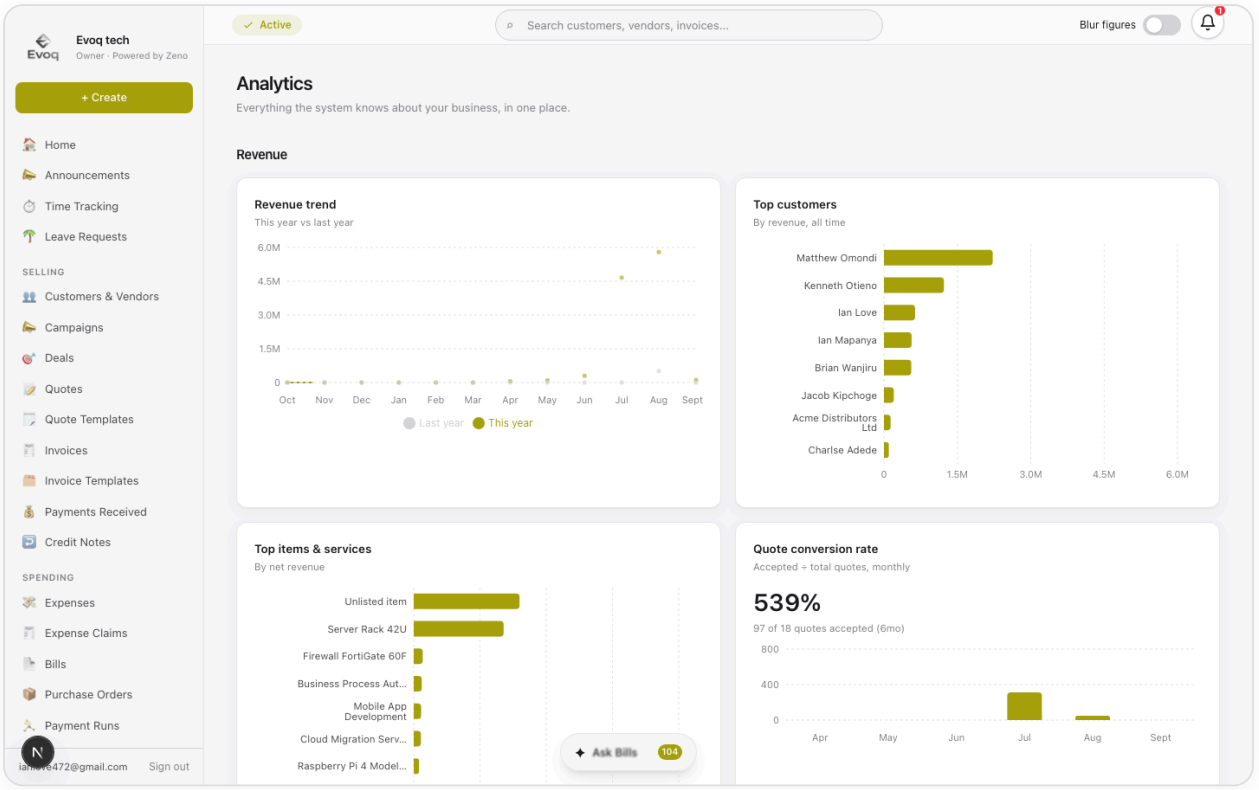
MONEY INSIGHTS

Reports is the compliance layer; Analytics is the decision layer — revenue trend, activity rings, top customers, quote conversion.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant · HR



Reports — trial balance, P&L, VAT.



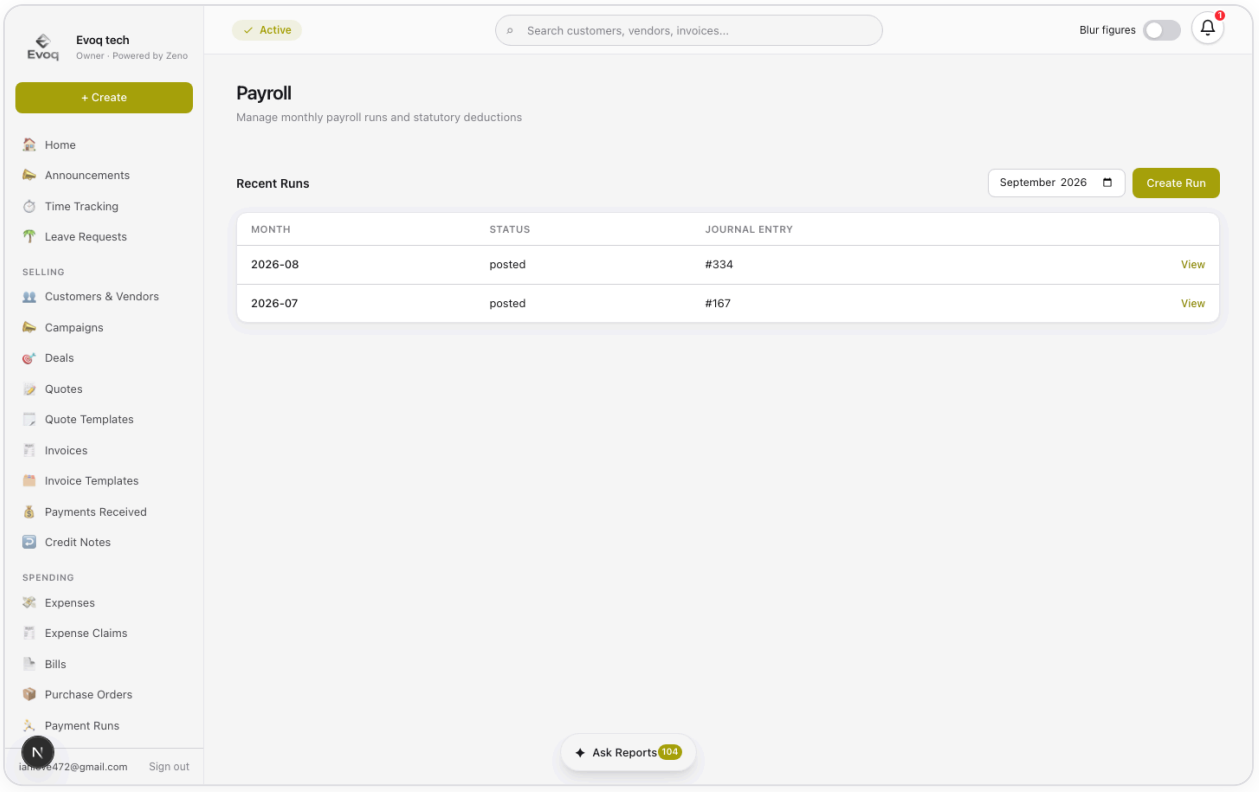
Analytics — activity rings and invoice mix.

16 Payroll

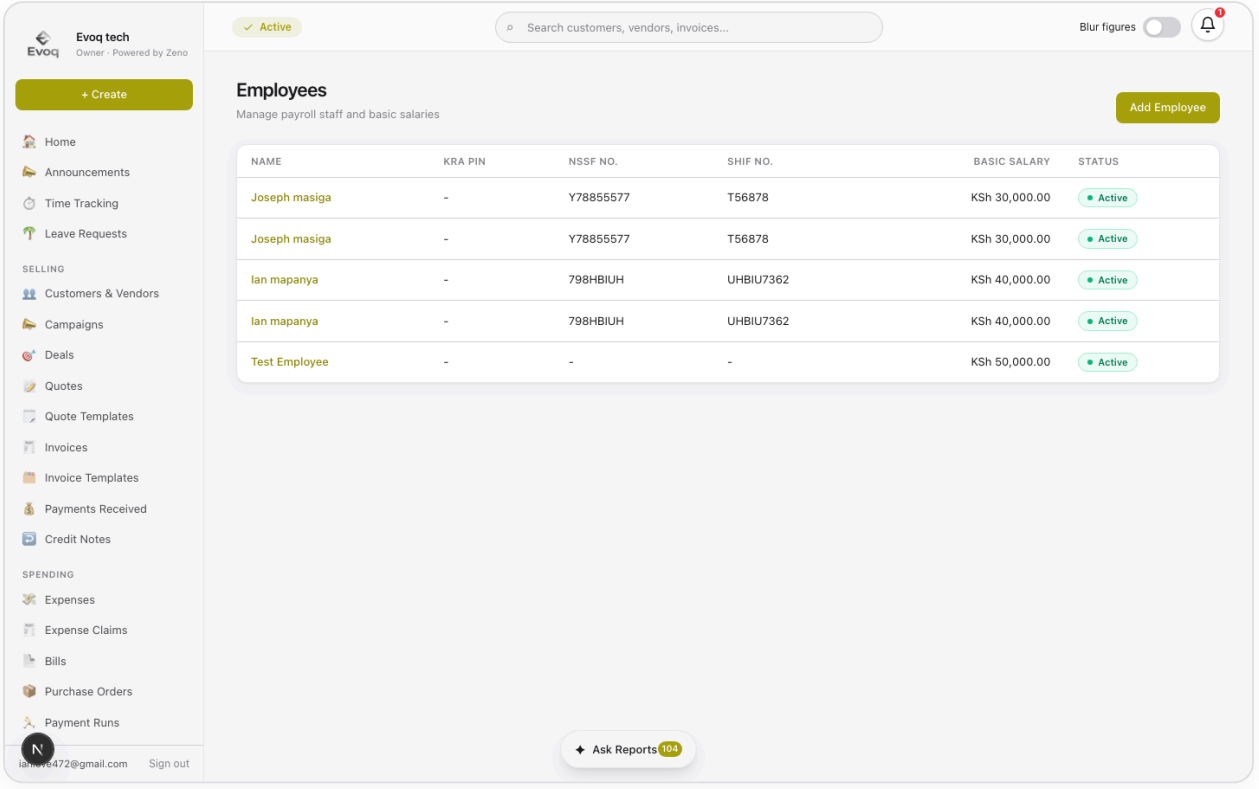
HR MONEY

Posting is two steps: "Post to Ledger" accrues the liability, "Record Salary Payment" clears it against a real account.

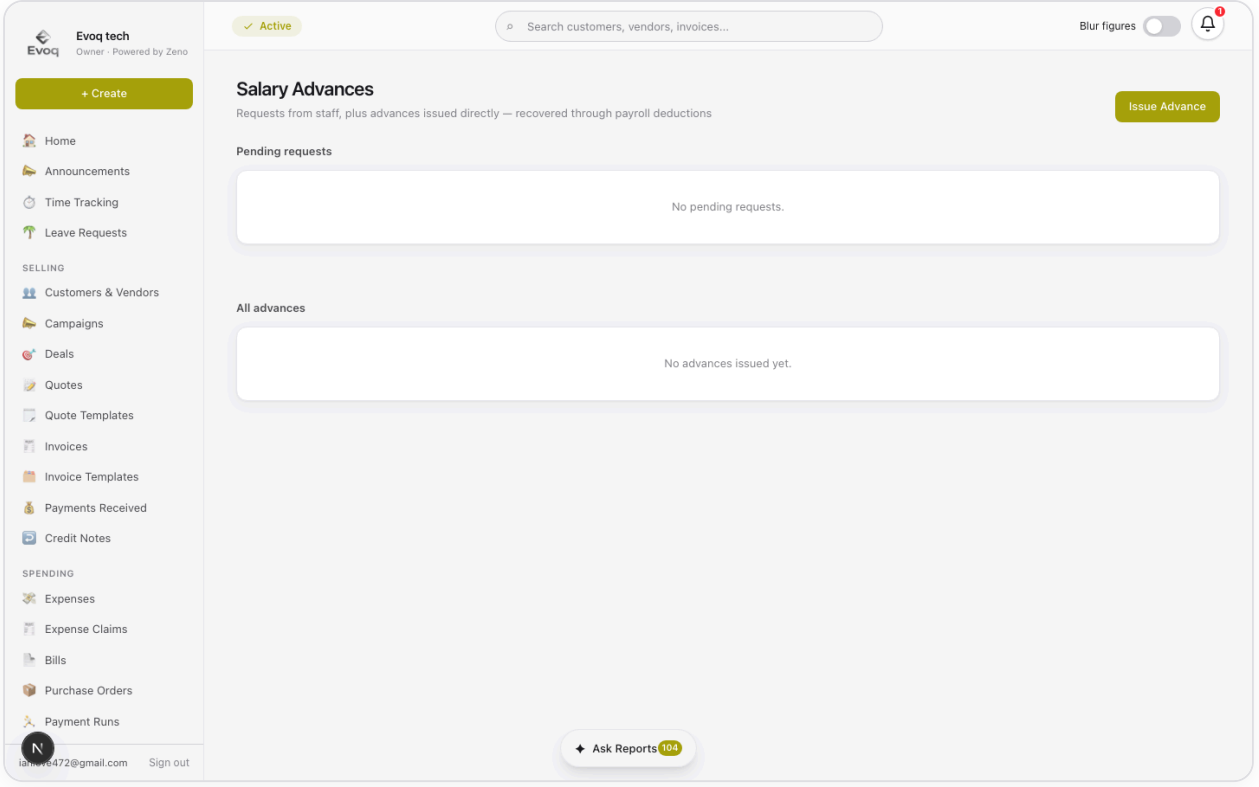
Roles Admin / Owner · HR



Payroll Runs.



Employees.



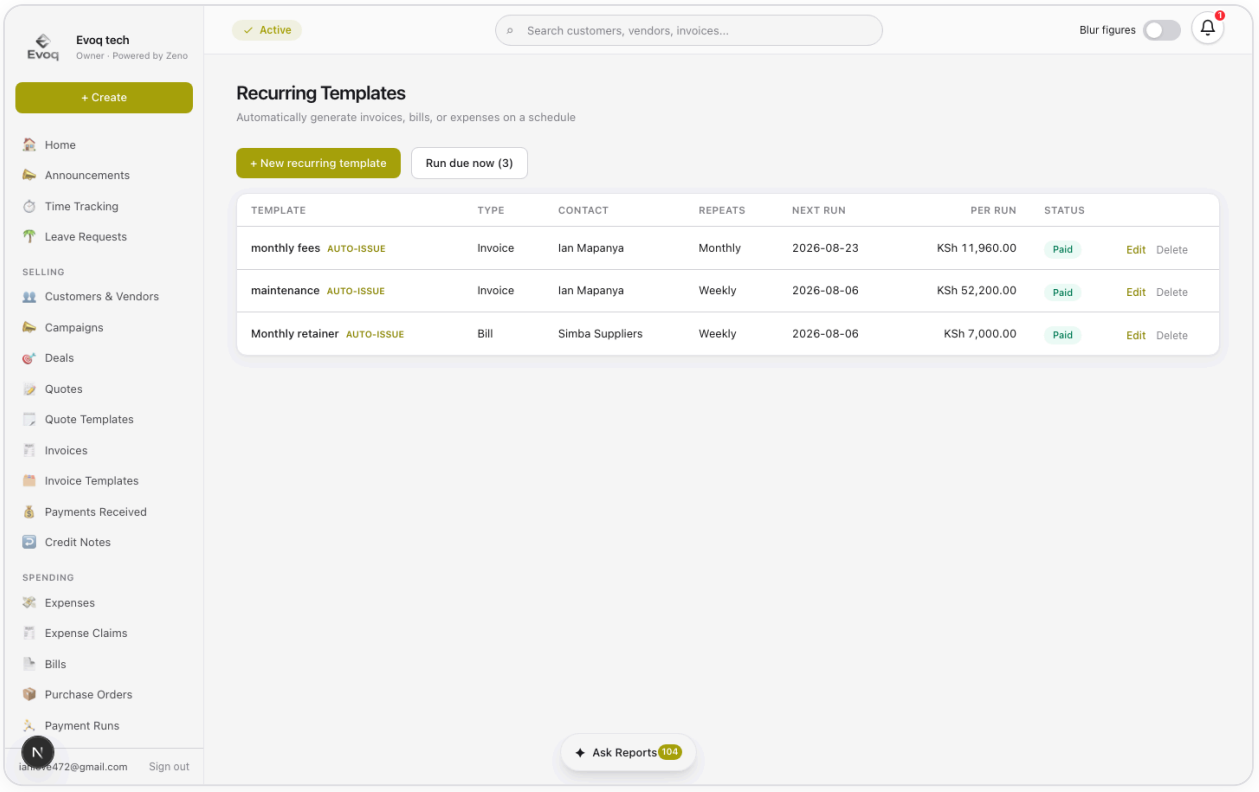
Salary Advances.

17 Recurring Templates

MONEY AUTOMATION

Due date can be a genuine "due at end of next month" calendar rule, not a coincidence of the day-count picked.

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant



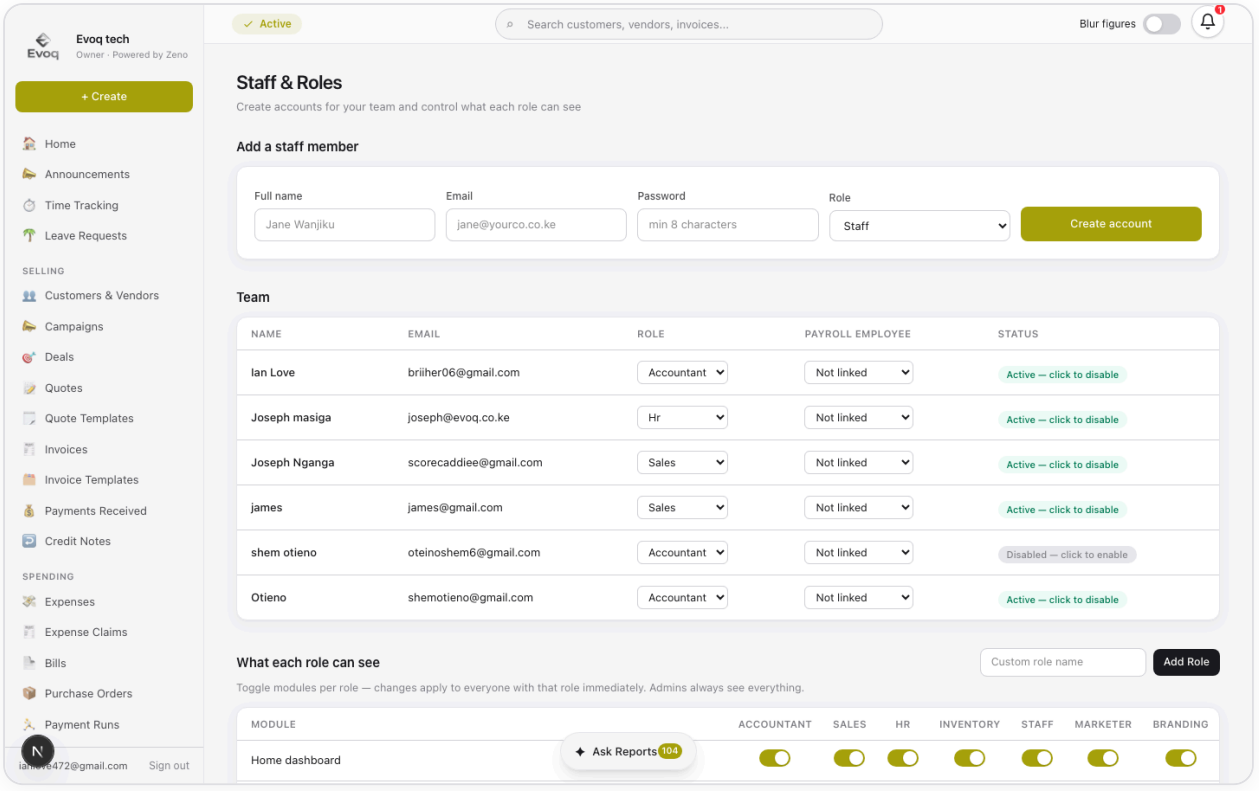
Recurring Templates.

18 Staff & Roles

ADMIN

Toggling a module for a role applies to everyone with that role, immediately. Marketer is the newest built-in role — full contacts create/follow-up, campaigns, expense claims, and zero financial visibility anywhere.

Roles Admin / Owner



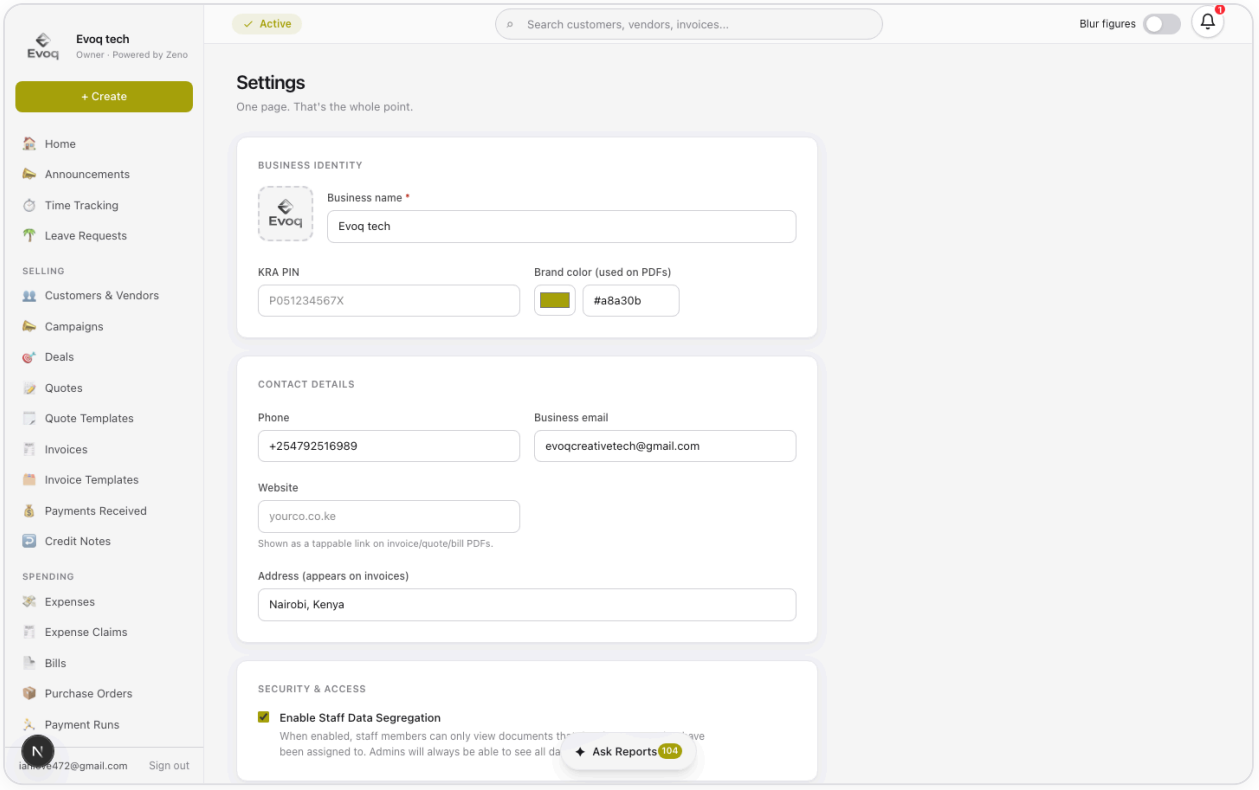
Staff & Roles — the full permission matrix, live.

19 Settings & Billing

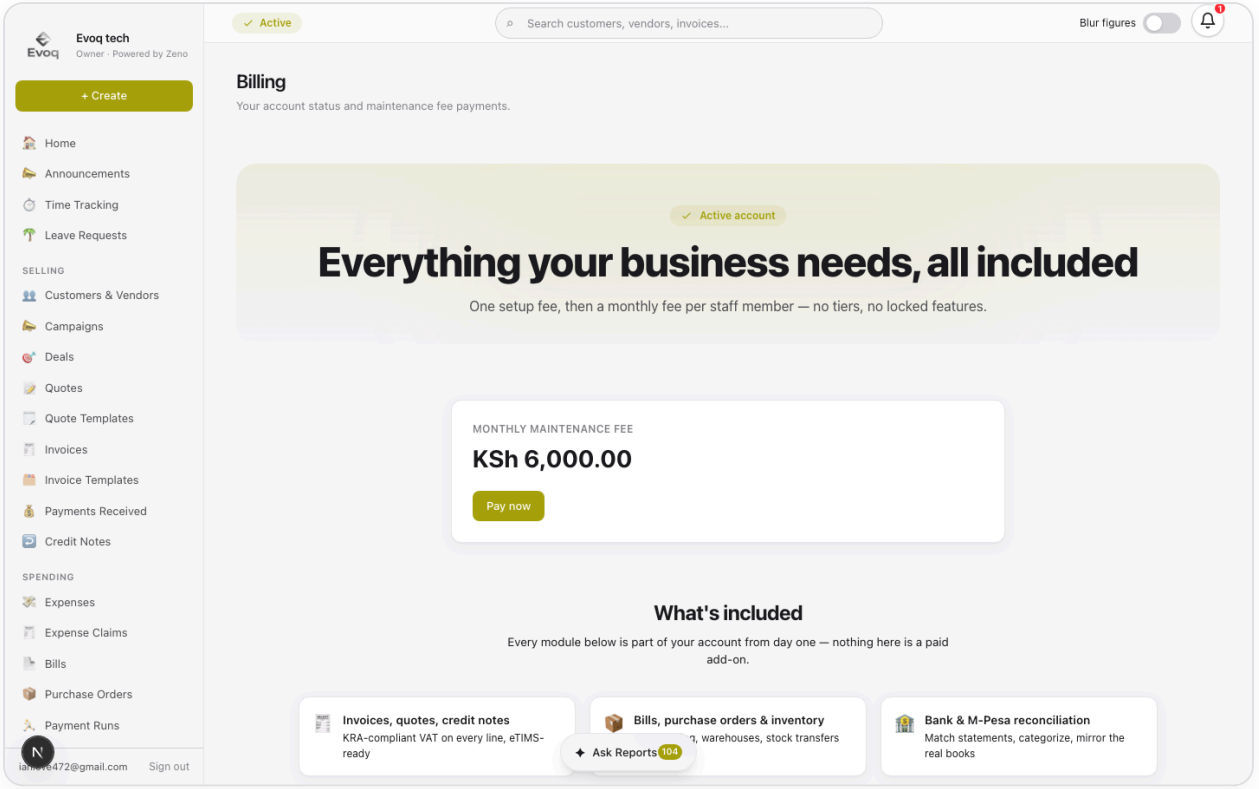
ADMIN

Business Identity, payment gateways, document numbering; Billing shows your trial/active status.

Roles Admin / Owner



Settings.



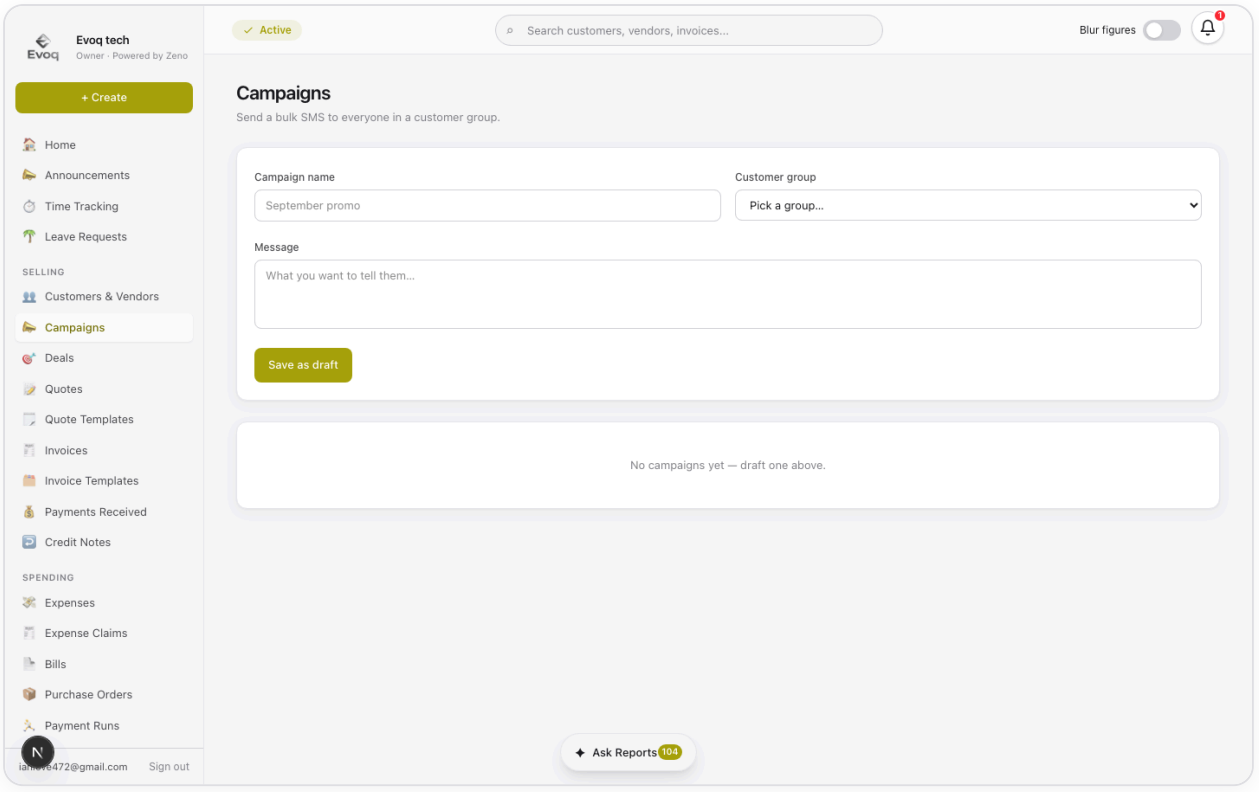
Billing.

20 Campaigns

SALES MARKETING

Send a bulk SMS to everyone in a customer group — a draft first, nothing sends until you click Send now.

Roles Admin / Owner · Marketer



Campaigns — compose and send.

21 End-to-End Walkthroughs

ORIENTATION

— A sale: Quote → sent → accepted → Convert to invoice → paid via M-Pesa STK → posts automatically.

— A purchase: Purchase Order → delivered → Convert to bill → paid or batched into a Payment Run.

— Payroll: run → PAYE/NSSF/SHIF/AHL calculated → Post to Ledger → Record Salary Payment.

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22 Glossary & Getting Help

REFERENCE

Contact

One shared record for a customer, vendor, or both.

Category heading

A bold, zero-price divider line grouping quote/invoice/bill lines into sections.

Post to Ledger

The step that turns a document into a real double-entry journal entry.

FIFO costing

Each stock purchase creates its own cost lot; a sale consumes the oldest lot first.

This guide also lives in-app under Settings → Documentation, filtered to what your own role can see. If something there doesn't match this PDF, the in-app version is current — this is a snapshot.

23 What's New — October 2026

UPDATE

Everything added to Zeno since this guide was first written, grouped by the section it belongs to. The in-app Documentation page (Settings → Documentation) already includes all of it, filtered to what your role can use.

Back button on every screen

ORIENTATION

Roles Everyone · see section 01

— Every screen except Home has a Back button (‹) at the left of the top bar, on desktop and mobile.

— It returns to the screen you were actually on. Opened fresh — a new tab, a bookmark, a link from an email — it goes up one level instead, e.g. from an invoice to the invoice list.

Merge quotes

SALES MONEY

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant · Sales · see section 07

— In the Quotes list, tick two or more draft, sent or accepted quotes for the same customer, then click **Merge into one quote**.

— A new draft quote is created with each original's lines under a "From QT-…" heading, so you can still see what came from where.

— The originals are marked **Merged** and link to the new quote — they can't also be converted to invoices.

— Quote PDFs no longer show payment details or payment terms; those appear on invoices only.

Discount on the whole invoice or quote

SALES MONEY

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant · Sales · see sections 07, 08

Next to the totals, type a discount for the whole document and choose **%** or **KSh**. It works on invoices, quotes and credit notes, on top of any per-line Disc %. Both kinds of discount show under the totals — in the editor, on the document page and on the PDF:

```
Subtotal                KSh 20,000.00
Line discounts        - KSh  1,000.00
Discount (10%)        - KSh  1,900.00
Subtotal before VAT     KSh 17,100.00
VAT                     KSh  2,736.00
Total                   KSh 19,836.00
```

— The discount comes off before VAT, so VAT is charged on the discounted price. On VAT-inclusive documents it comes off the VAT-inclusive price.

— Revenue, VAT returns and reports all use the discounted amounts automatically.

— It carries over when a quote becomes an invoice, when an invoice becomes a credit note, and onto templates.

Withholding VAT filled in automatically

SALES MONEY

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant · see section 08

— When the customer is a KRA withholding agent, **Record payment** fills in the 2% withholding VAT for you.

— Enter what actually arrived in the bank as the amount. The amount received plus the WHT clears the invoice in full — it shows **Paid**, not Partly paid.

23 What's New — continued

Edit bills and purchase orders before payment

SPENDING

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant · Inventory · see section 10

— A bill has an **Edit** button until it's paid: while a draft, awaiting approval, or recorded but unpaid — for example when the vendor delivers more goods later the same day.

— Saving a recorded bill re-posts it with the new amounts and stock quantities. If your organisation requires bill approval, the edited bill goes back for approval unless you can approve it yourself.

— A bill with a payment or credit against it, or sitting in a payment run, can't be edited.

— A purchase order can be edited while a draft or sent, until any part of it is billed. After that, raise a new PO for the extra items.

Business Loans

MONEY

Roles Admin / Owner · Accountant · sidebar: Business Loans

Money the business has borrowed — from a bank, SACCO, M-Pesa loan, asset financier or a director — and its repayments.

— **Record a loan**: the amount borrowed, the date, and the account it was received into — or mark it as already in the books (an opening balance or manual journal).

— Optionally add a flat interest rate (% per year) or a total interest amount, and the term in months. The outstanding balance then includes the interest, and each month's share is expensed automatically at month-end.

— **Record payment** on the loan reduces the outstanding balance and posts the payment from the account you choose.

Staff loans repaid outside payroll

HR MONEY

Roles Admin / Owner · HR · Accountant · see section 16

— When an employee repays a loan in cash, M-Pesa or by bank, open the loan and use **Record Repayment**. It reduces the balance just like a payroll deduction and appears under Direct Repayments.

— A loan issued without saying where the money came from is flagged **Disbursement not recorded** until it's fixed from the loan's page.

Days worked on a payroll run

HR MONEY

Roles Admin / Owner · HR · Accountant · see section 16

— A draft payroll run has a **Days worked** column, shown as e.g. "20 of 26". Type a new number — half days are allowed — and press Enter.

— That employee's basic pay is pro-rated: basic salary × days worked ÷ the month's working days (Monday to Saturday). PAYE, NSSF, SHIF and Housing Levy are recalculated on the new gross; adjustments and loan deductions stay.

— Days start at the month's working days less any unpaid leave, are locked once the run is posted, and appear on the payslip as "Basic Salary (20 of 26 days)".

> NOTE
> Example: KSh 52,000 basic for 20 of 26 working days = KSh 40,000 gross before deductions.